Your Father Who *Sees in Secret*

The Father is unseen, so His children give, pray and fast unseen.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 6:1-18 in the LSB | 25:05 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: This SECRET Is HIDDEN in Matthew 6! (Matthew 6:1-18). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 6:1-18: don't do your righteousness to be seen. Three examples follow: giving to the poor, prayer (with the Lord's Prayer) and fasting. Each time, the hypocrites 'have their reward in full,' and 'your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.'
- First, a promise behind the whole sermon: God must change the heart. Jeremiah 31:33 (the law written on the heart) and Ezekiel 36:25-27 (clean water, a new heart, God's Spirit), which Jesus draws on with Nicodemus in John 3. The sermon is not 'just try harder.'
- A hypocrite in Jesus' day was a Greek stage actor. Jesus' disciples must not perform their righteousness for applause.
- The teacher suggests the whole sermon may be a chiasm with the Lord's Prayer at its center, and the prayer itself a chiasm centered on 'on earth as it is in heaven.' He says plainly this is debated and he is still chewing on it.
- The key word is 'reward.' It starts at 5:46 ('what reward do you have?'), so chapter 6 extends the end of chapter 5: string together 5:20, 5:46, 5:48 and 6:1 and it's all connected.
- The lesson: the Father blesses everyone, the just and the unjust, not to be seen but because He loves. So we do

> *"Something must take place in our hearts, and it has to be done by God.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

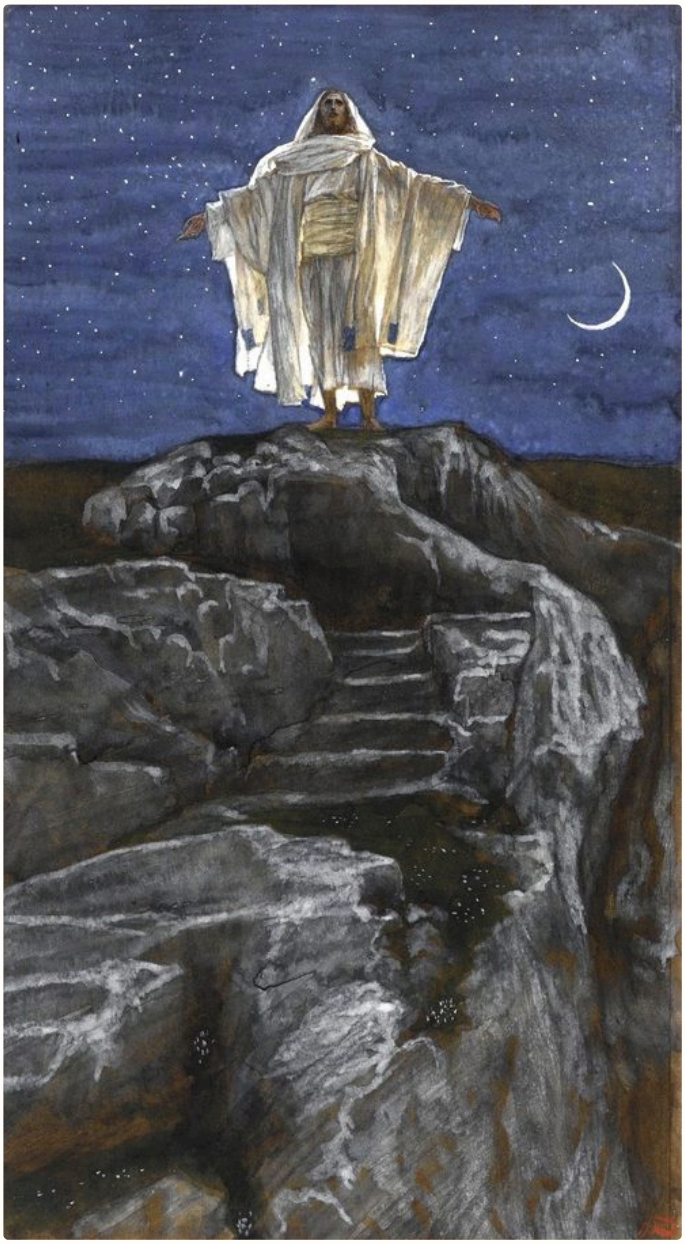
> *"A hypocrite in Jesus' day was a Greek actor... all of this was just a performance, and it was meant for the crowd's applause.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

our righteousness in secret, because our Father is in secret. The commands reveal the Father's heart, and knowing Him leads to intimacy with Him.



'Pray, then, in this way' (6:9)

James Tissot, The Lord's Prayer, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



'Go into your inner room' (6:6)

James Tissot, Jesus Goes Up Alone onto a Mountain to Pray, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Lay chapters 5 and 6 side by side

The teacher asks you to open Matthew 5 on the left and Matthew 6 on the right, and to track one repeated word: 'reward.' Underline it every time (5:46; 6:1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 16, 18). Then look for other repeated words and phrases on your own.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 6:1-18, then traces links to chapter 5 and the prophets. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 6:1-18
Read in full: giving, prayer, the Lord's Prayer, and fasting.

Jeremiah 31:31-34
The new covenant: 'on their heart I will write it.'

Ezekiel 36:25-27
Clean water, a new heart, and God's Spirit within.

John 3:3-8
The video: 'born of water and the Spirit' points back to Ezekiel 36.

Matthew 5:20
The clash between Jesus' disciples and the scribes and Pharisees begins here.

Matthew 5:46-48
'What reward do you have?' The word 'reward' first appears.

Genesis 1:26-27
Made in God's image: 'on earth as it is in heaven' takes the teacher back here.

1 John 2:3-6
'Walk in the same manner as He walked.'

John 15:1-11
The video's 'abiding' passage.

Matthew 6:19-34
Coming next (Episode 9): treasure, the eye, two masters and worry.

Key verses in the LSB

“Beware of doing your righteousness before men to be noticed by them; otherwise you have no reward with your Father who is in heaven.”
Matthew 6:1 (LSB)

“But you, when you pray, go into your inner room, and when you have shut your door, pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.”
Matthew 6:6 (LSB)

“Your kingdom come. / Your will be done, / On earth as it is in heaven.”
Matthew 6:10 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

First, a new heart

Before chapter 6, the teacher pauses on the promise the whole sermon presupposes: God must change the heart.



PROMISE · JEREMIAH 31

The law written on the heart

✍ JEREMIAH 31:33 (LSB)

NEW COVENANT

“But this is the covenant which I will cut with the house of Israel after those days,” declares Yahweh: “I will put My law within them, and on their heart I will write it; and I will be their God, and they shall be My people.”

FROM THE VIDEO Something ontologically significant must take place, done by God to our hearts. The Sermon on the Mount presupposes these promises.

BACKGROUND Hebrews quotes this passage at length as fulfilled in Christ (Hebrews 8:8-12), and Jesus speaks of 'the new covenant in My blood' (Luke 22:20). Hebrews 8:8-12 Luke 22:20



PROMISE · EZEKIEL 36

Clean water, a new heart, My Spirit

💧 EZEKIEL 36:26-27 (LSB)

NEW HEART

“Moreover, I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; and I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, and you will be careful to do My judgments.”

FROM THE VIDEO This is what Jesus refers to when He tells Nicodemus about being born of water and the Spirit (John 3): the cleansing water of Ezekiel 36:25 and the Spirit of 36:26-27. Ezekiel 36:25 John 3:5

BACKGROUND Jesus chides Nicodemus as 'the teacher of Israel' for not understanding (John 3:10), which fits an Old Testament background like Ezekiel 36. John 3:10

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit



THE RESULT · 1 JOHN 2

Walk as He walked

🚶 1 JOHN 2:5-6 (LSB)

ABIDE

“but whoever keeps His word, truly in him the love of God has been perfected. By this we know that we are in Him: the one who says he abides in Him ought himself to walk in the same manner as He walked.”

FROM THE VIDEO The sermon should not freak a disciple out with 'a ton of new commands.' It connects to the psalmist's love of God's law (Psalm 119), to abiding in Jesus (John 15:1-11) and to 1 John 2: we perform our righteousness in the same way He did.

Psalm 119:11 John 15:9-11

> *"Something must take place in our hearts, and it has to be done by God.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

String the verses together

The video's discovery: chapter 6 extends the end of chapter 5. Read these four verses in a row, as the teacher does.

MATTHEW 5:20, 46, 48 AND 6:1 (LSB)

5:20 For I say to you that unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven.

5:46 For if you love those who love you, what reward do you have? Do not even the tax collectors do the same?

5:48 Therefore you are to be perfect, as your heavenly Father is perfect.

6:1 Beware of doing your righteousness before men to be noticed by them; otherwise you have no reward with your Father who is in heaven.

'It's all connected. You see it?' The righteousness that surpasses (5:20) is love like the Father's (5:46-48), done for the Father, not for an audience (6:1).

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Giving, prayer and fasting, in secret

Follow the word 'reward' (highlighted), then the three pictures: the hypocrite's way (left) and the Father's way (right).

THE REWARD CHAIN (LSB)

Starts here **5:46** For if you love those who love you, what reward do you have?

Warning **6:1** Beware of doing your righteousness before men to be noticed by them; otherwise you have no reward with your Father who is in heaven.

Giving **6:2** Truly I say to you, they have their reward in full.

Giving 6:4 so that your giving will be in secret; and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.

Prayer 6:5 Truly I say to you, they have their reward in full.

Prayer 6:6 pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.

Fasting 6:16 Truly I say to you, they have their reward in full.

Fasting 6:18 so that your fasting will not be noticed by men, but by your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.

Coral: the hypocrites are paid in full by applause. Teal: the Father who sees in secret rewards.



GIVING · MATTHEW 6:2-4

When you give to the poor

LIKE THE HYPOCRITES · MATTHEW 6:2

“Therefore, when you give to the poor, do not sound a trumpet before you, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, so that they may be glorified by men.”

LIKE YOUR FATHER · MATTHEW 6:3-4

“But when you give to the poor, do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing, so that your giving will be in secret; and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.”

FROM THE VIDEO The 'greater' righteousness of 5:20 is not more actions performed for others to see. It is righteousness that pierces and transforms the heart, unseen by the person on the street.

BACKGROUND Whether 'sound a trumpet' is a figure of speech or points to something real is debated. The Mishnah describes thirteen 'collection horns' in the temple, 'narrow at the top and wide at the bottom' (Shekalim 6:1, William Davidson edition, CC BY-NC, via Sefaria).

Augustine on the left hand: 'the left hand seems to have no more suitable meaning than just this delight in praise' (On the Sermon on the Mount, Book 2).



PRAYER · MATTHEW 6:5-8

When you pray

LIKE THE HYPOCRITES · MATTHEW 6:5

“And when you pray, you are not to be like the hypocrites; for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and on the street corners so that they may be seen by men.”

LIKE YOUR FATHER · MATTHEW 6:6

“But you, when you pray, go into your inner room, and when you have shut your door, pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.”

FROM THE VIDEO Not like the Greek actors who blow the trumpets, not like those who do things to be lauded on the street corners, but like the Father does.

BACKGROUND A second warning follows: 'do not use meaningless repetition as the Gentiles do... for your Father knows what you need before you ask Him' (6:7-8). The 'inner room' (tameion) was often a storeroom, the one room with a door. Matthew 6:7-8

2 Kings 4:33

FASTING · MATTHEW 6:16-18

When you fast

LIKE THE HYPOCRITES · MATTHEW 6:16

“Now whenever you fast, do not put on a gloomy face as the hypocrites do, for they neglect their appearance so that they will be noticed by men when they are fasting.”

LIKE YOUR FATHER · MATTHEW 6:17-18

“But you, when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face so that your fasting will not be noticed by men, but by your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.”

FROM THE VIDEO Once again Jesus contrasts His disciples with the Greek actors, the hypocrites who perform for applause.

BACKGROUND There is a wordplay in 6:16: they make their faces disappear (aphanizō, 'neglect their appearance') so that they may appear (phainō, 'be noticed'). Isaiah had already asked what kind of fast God chooses (Isaiah 58:5-7). Isaiah 58:3-7

The Didache, an early Christian manual, says: 'But let not your fasts be with the hypocrites; for they fast on the second and fifth day of the week; but fast on the fourth day and the Preparation (Friday).'

◆ Factbook: Fasting



'As the hypocrites do' (6:2)

James Tissot, Woe unto You, Scribes and Pharisees, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *A hypocrite in Jesus' day was a Greek actor... all of this was just a performance, and it was meant for the crowd's applause.*
>
> From the video

06 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

The Lord's Prayer

The video suggests the prayer may be a chiasm with one line at its center, and says this is debated. Here is the prayer in the LSB, laid out that way, then four lines with an Old Testament echo.

MATTHEW 6:9-13 (LSB), IN THE VIDEO'S SUGGESTED SHAPE

6:9 Our Father who is in heaven,

6:9 Hallowed be Your name.

6:10 Your kingdom come.

6:10 Your will be done,

6:10 On earth as it is in heaven.

6:11 Give us this day our daily bread.

6:12 And forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors.

6:13 And do not lead us into temptation,

6:13 but deliver us from the evil one.

One proposed layout, not the only one. The LSB adds in brackets 'For Yours is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen,' which the earliest manuscripts do not have.



MATTHEW 6:9

Hallowed be Your name

EZEKIEL · EZEKIEL 36:23

"I will prove the holiness of My great name which has been profaned among the nations"

JESUS · MATTHEW 6:9

"Our Father who is in heaven, / Hallowed be Your name."

BACKGROUND The same chapter of Ezekiel that promises a new heart begins with God making His name holy. To pray 'hallowed be Your name' is to ask God to do it. Ezekiel 36:22-23



MATTHEW 6:10 · THE VIDEO'S CENTER

On earth as it is in heaven

CREATION · GENESIS 1:27

"And God created man in His own image, in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."

JESUS · MATTHEW 6:10

"Your kingdom come. / Your will be done, / On earth as it is in heaven."

FROM THE VIDEO If the prayer is a chiasm, this line is its center, and it would make sense of the sermon's focus on the kingdom. It takes us back to Genesis 1, being created in the image of God to mirror God.

DEBATED The teacher says this layout is debated, and he is still chewing on it. Many read the prayer simply as two sets of requests: three for God's name, kingdom and will, then requests for our needs.

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven ◆ Factbook: Image of God

MATTHEW 6:11

Our daily bread

THE MANNA · EXODUS 16:4

“Behold, I will rain bread from heaven for you; and the people shall go out and gather a day’s portion every day”

JESUS · MATTHEW 6:11

“Give us this day our daily bread.”

BACKGROUND Bread for each day, gathered day by day: Israel learned daily dependence in the wilderness. The rare word for 'daily' (epiousios) is discussed below in Hebrew and Greek words. Exodus 16:4-5 Deuteronomy 8:3

◆ Factbook: Manna

MATTHEW 6:12-15

Forgive us, as we forgive

MATTHEW 6:14-15 (LSB) REPEATED

“For if you forgive others for their transgressions, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you do not forgive others, then your Father will not forgive your transgressions.”

BACKGROUND The only petition Jesus explains afterward. He tells a whole parable about it later, ending: 'My heavenly Father will also do the same to you, if each of you does not forgive his brother from your hearts' (Matthew 18:35). 'Do not lead us into temptation' recalls Jesus' own testing (4:1) and Gethsemane (26:41). Matthew 18:21-35 Matthew 26:41

Cyprian of Carthage (c. AD 252): 'Our prayer is public and common; and when we pray, we pray not for one, but for the whole people, because we the whole people are one' (On the Lord's Prayer, 8).

> *“Our heavenly Father is in secret. Our actions and our motives should be hidden, just like our Father.*
>
> From the video

07

Who's who in 6:1-18

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

The Father in heaven

VIDEO Reveals the Father: every 'do this' shows how the Father operates, unseen, blessing all.

BACKGROUND Jesus Himself often prayed alone: 'He went up on the mountain by Himself to pray' (Matthew 14:23).

Matthew 14:23 | John 5:19 | ◆ Jesus Christ

VIDEO Unseen, in secret, blessing the just and the unjust because He loves, not to be seen.

BACKGROUND 'Father' appears ten times in 6:1-18 in the LSB, more than anywhere else in the sermon.

Matthew 6:1-18 | Matthew 5:45

The hypocrites

VIDEO The Greek word for a stage actor: people who perform righteousness for applause. In the sermon they are the scribes and Pharisees of 5:20.

BACKGROUND Matthew uses 'hypocrites' more than any other Gospel, especially in the woes of chapter 23.

Matthew 23:13-15 | Matthew 15:7-8 | ◆ Pharisees | ◆ Hypocrite

The Gentiles

VIDEO Their prayers heap up many words, as if to be heard for them (6:7).

BACKGROUND The pagan prayers of the day often piled up divine names and titles to make sure the right god was addressed.

Matthew 6:7-8 | 1 Kings 18:26-29 | ◆ Gentiles

Nicodemus

VIDEO Jesus tells him about being born of water and the Spirit (John 3), pointing back to Ezekiel 36.

BACKGROUND A Pharisee and 'a ruler of the Jews' who came to Jesus by night (John 3:1-2) and later helped bury Him (John 19:39).

John 3:1-10 | John 19:39 | ◆ Pharisees | ◆ Nicodemus

The disciples and the crowds

VIDEO The audience again: the disciples, with the crowds who came and sat to hear.

BACKGROUND The Lord's Prayer is given to disciples: 'Pray, then, in this way' (6:9). Luke places it after a disciple asks, 'Lord, teach us to pray' (Luke 11:1).

Luke 11:1-4 | ◆ Disciples

08 · BACKGROUND

Synagogues around the lake

'They love to stand and pray in the synagogues' (6:5). Gold pins are background: places where synagogue remains have been found.



● Named in the video ● Background

'In the synagogues and on the street corners' (6:5): towns around the lake where synagogue remains have been found. Positions from known sites. Coastline of the lake and rivers: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL); land: Natural Earth (public domain).

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' home base. The white synagogue visitors see is later, built on an older basalt foundation.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Magdala BACKGROUND

A 1st-century synagogue, in use in Jesus' day, was uncovered here in 2009.

◆ Factbook: Magdala

Chorazin BACKGROUND

Its basalt synagogue ruins date from a few centuries after Jesus.

◆ Factbook: Chorazin

Arbel BACKGROUND

Cliffs above the lake with the remains of a later synagogue.

Mount of Beatitudes BACKGROUND
The traditional site of the sermon.

◆ Factbook: Mount of Beatitudes (traditional site)

Tiberias BACKGROUND
Herod Antipas' capital, founded around AD 20.

◆ Factbook: Tiberias

Bethsaida BACKGROUND
Home town of Andrew and Peter (John 1:44).

◆ Factbook: Bethsaida

Nazareth BACKGROUND
Jesus' hometown, where He taught in the synagogue (Luke 4:16).

◆ Factbook: Nazareth

09

Key terms

Hypocrite

VIDEO

Greek hypokritēs: a stage actor, who played a part behind a mask. Jesus uses it for people whose religion is a performance.

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

Righteousness (6:1)

BACKGROUND

Here, acts of devotion: giving, prayer and fasting, the three pillars of Jewish piety.

◆ Factbook: Righteousness

Giving to the poor (alms)

BACKGROUND

Greek eleēmosynē, from eleos, mercy: the root of 'alms.' Linked to 'Blessed are the merciful' (5:7).

◆ Factbook: Almsgiving

Have their reward in full

BACKGROUND

Apechō was used on business receipts: 'paid in full.' The applause is all they will get.

Chiasm

VIDEO

A mirrored pattern with a center. The video suggests the whole sermon and the Lord's Prayer may each be chiastic, and says this is debated.

◆ Factbook: Chiasm

The Lord's Prayer

BACKGROUND

The model prayer of 6:9-13 (also Luke 11:2-4). The closing doxology, 'For Yours is the kingdom...,' is in brackets in the LSB because the earliest manuscripts lack it.

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven ◆ Factbook: Prayer

Fasting

BACKGROUND

New covenant

VIDEO

Going without food for a time to seek God. The Day of Atonement's 'humble your souls' (Leviticus 16:29) was kept by fasting; the Pharisee in Jesus' parable says, 'I fast twice a week' (Luke 18:12).

◆ Factbook: Fasting

God's promise to write His law on the heart (Jeremiah 31:31-34), the backdrop the video gives for the sermon.

◆ Factbook: New covenant

10 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

μισθός

misthos G3408

Wages, pay, reward. The noun in 5:46 and 6:1, 2, 5, 16.

Greek · Matt 5:46; 6:1, 2, 5, 16

ἀποδίδωμι

apodidōmi G591

To give back, repay (LSB 'reward'). The Father's answer in 6:4, 6, 18.

Greek · Matt 6:4, 6, 18

ἀπέχω

apechō G568

To receive in full; a word used on receipts. Look up: BDAG, ἀπέχω.

Greek · Matt 6:2, 5, 16

ὑποκριτής

hypokritēs G5273

Actor, pretender: one who plays a part.

Greek · Matt 6:2, 5, 16

◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

θεάομαι

theaomai G2300

To look at, behold, as a spectator (LSB 'noticed'). Related to theatron, 'theater.'

Greek · Matt 6:1

κρυπτός

kryptos G2927

Hidden, secret ('crypt'). 6:18 uses the related kryphaios (G2931a).

Greek · Matt 6:4, 6

ταμεῖον

tameion G5009

Inner room, storeroom.

Greek · Matt 6:6

βατταλογέω

battalogeō G945

To babble, use empty words (LSB 'use meaningless repetition'). Found only here in the New Testament.

Greek · Matt 6:7

◆ Factbook: Prayer

ἁγιάζω

hagiazō G37

To make holy, treat as holy (LSB 'Hallowed').

Greek · Matt 6:9

ἐπιούσιος

epiousios G1967

Daily: a rare word whose exact sense is debated ('for today,' 'for tomorrow,' or 'needed'). Look up: BDAG, ἐπιούσιος.

Greek · Matt 6:11

◆ Factbook: Manna

ὀφείλημα

opheilēma G3783

Debt; sin pictured as a debt owed to God. 6:14-15 switches to paraptōma, 'transgression.'

Greek · Matt 6:12

πειρασμός

peirasmos G3986

Testing, temptation: the same root as Jesus' testing in the wilderness (4:1).

Greek · Matt 6:13

◆ Factbook: Temptation of Jesus

ἀφανίζω

aphanizō G853

To make unseen, disfigure (LSB 'neglect their appearance'); a play on phainō, 'appear.'

Greek · Matt 6:16

νηστεύω

nēsteuō G3522

To fast.

Greek · Matt 6:16, 18

◆ Factbook: Fasting

לֵב

lev H3820

Heart: the inner person, mind and will. 'On their heart I will write it.'

Hebrew · Jer 31:33; Ezek 36:26

בְּרִית

berit H1285

Covenant.

Hebrew · Jer 31:33

◆ Factbook: New covenant

11

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Three pillars of piety

Giving to the poor, prayer and fasting were the core acts of Jewish devotion. Jesus assumes His disciples will do all three: 'when you give,' 'when you pray,' 'when you fast.'

Greek theater in Galilee

Theaters stood in the Decapolis cities and later in Sepphoris, near Nazareth, so 'hypocrite' was a familiar word. Actors wore masks to play their parts.

Set times of prayer

Jews prayed at fixed times, often morning, afternoon and evening, wherever they were (compare Daniel 6:10; Acts 3:1). Being 'caught' on a street corner at prayer time could become a show.

Fasting customs

The Pharisee in Jesus' parable fasts 'twice a week' (Luke 18:12); the Didache names Monday and Thursday as the 'hypocrites'' days. Fasters might skip washing and oiling their hair and wear sackcloth and ashes. Jesus says: look normal.

The Lord's Prayer in the early church

The Didache, an early Christian manual (c. AD 100), gives the prayer in Matthew's form with a doxology and says: 'Thrice in the day thus pray.'

SOURCED Early witnesses

> *Neither pray as the hypocrites; but as the Lord commanded in His Gospel, thus pray: Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be Your name.*
>
> The Didache, c. AD 50-120. Didache 8 (Roberts-Donaldson translation, public domain). It closes: 'Thrice in the day thus pray.'

> *And well has He called them hypocrites for the mask was of mercy, but the spirit of cruelty and inhumanity.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 19, on 6:2. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *Our prayer is public and common; and when we pray, we pray not for one, but for the whole people, because we the whole people are one.*
>
> Cyprian of Carthage, c. AD 252. On the Lord's Prayer, 8. Ante-Nicene Fathers, vol. 5 (public domain).

DEBATED Where scholars differ

Is the whole sermon a chiasm?

Some scholars arrange Matthew 5-7 symmetrically with the Lord's Prayer at the center; others see a different structure (for example, 'the Law and the Prophets' at 5:17 and 7:12 framing the body). The video offers it as an invitation to study.

Is the Lord's Prayer a chiasm?

The video's center is 'on earth as it is in heaven.' Many read the prayer as three 'Your' petitions followed by three or four 'us' petitions. Either way, heaven's will on earth is a key line.

Who are the hypocrites?

'Daily' bread

The video stresses actors performing for applause. Others stress that Jesus' 'hypocrites' are also self-deceived: they 'say things and do not do them' (23:3). Both point to a gap between show and heart.

Epiousios is almost unknown outside the Lord's Prayer: bread for today, for the coming day, or what is needed. Some early writers also read it of spiritual bread.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The captions say 'Matthew chapter 6 verses 1-8'; the passage read is 6:1-18.
- In English 'reward' repeats through 6:1-18, but Greek uses two words: the noun misthos (5:46; 6:1, 2, 5, 16) and the verb apodidōmi, 'repay' (6:4, 6, 18). The chain the video traces still holds.
- Hypokritēs did mean a stage actor. The touring troupes with trumpets and painted faces are an illustration rather than something the text says; Greek actors usually wore masks.
- 'Everything Jesus says in the Gospels is either a quotation from the Old Testament or an allusion to it' is a strong claim. Very much of it is, which is why the video's method works so well.
- The two chiasms (the whole sermon and the Lord's Prayer) are proposals; the video says so itself.

12 · BACKGROUND

From manna to the Didache

Coral dots mark what Matthew 6:1-18 echoes or tells. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 OR 1260 BC DEBATED

Manna: 'a day's portion every day'

Exodus 16:4 *Echo: 6:11*

C. 590 BC

Jeremiah: the law written on the heart

Jeremiah 31:33 *Background*

C. 585 BC

Ezekiel: a new heart and God's Spirit

Ezekiel 36:25-27 *Background*

C. AD 28 DEBATED

The Sermon on the Mount: giving, prayer and fasting in secret

Matthew 6:1-18 *This episode*

C. AD 50-120 DEBATED

The Didache: pray the Lord's Prayer three times a day

Matthew 6:9-13

C. AD 252

Cyprian writes On the Lord's Prayer

Matthew 6:9

c. AD 390

Chrysostom preaches on Matthew 6

Matthew 6:2

13

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 11:1-13
'Lord, teach us to pray': Luke's form of the prayer
ADDED

Jeremiah 31:31-34
The new covenant written on the heart
ADDED

Ezekiel 36:22-27
God's holy name and a new heart
ADDED

Isaiah 58:3-9
The fast God chooses
ADDED

Exodus 16:4-5
Bread from heaven, day by day
ADDED

Matthew 18:21-35
The unforgiving servant
ADDED

Matthew 23:5-7
'They do all their deeds to be noticed by men'
ADDED

Matthew 26:36-44
Jesus prays 'Your will be done' in Gethsemane
ADDED

John 17
Jesus prays to the Father for His disciples
ADDED

1 John 2:3-6
Walk as He walked
ADDED

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Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ The video's side study: list every word or phrase Jesus repeats in 6:1-18. What patterns do you see?

2 ☐ Why does the sermon need Jeremiah 31 and Ezekiel 36 behind it? What happens if we read it as 'just try harder'?

3 ☐ Which of the three (giving, prayer, fasting) do you find hardest to do 'in secret'? Why?

4 ☐ Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly. Which line stands out to you as the center this week?

5 ☐ The video says the commands reveal the Father. What does 6:1-18 show you about the Father's heart?

6 ☐ What is the lesson for you today?

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Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson for the original audience: our heavenly Father extends His blessings to all, the just and the unjust, not to be seen but because He loves. So we perform our righteousness the same way, in secret, because our Father is in secret. Disciples must not act like actors blowing trumpets, but like the Father. The commands reveal His heart, His desires and His motives, and deeper understanding of the Father can lead to deeper intimacy with the Father. Now it's your turn: what is the lesson for you today?

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

try one secret act this week from each of the three: give something no one will know about, pray once behind a shut door, and skip one meal to pray without telling anyone. Then ask the Father what He showed you.

> *"Deeper understanding of the Father can lead to deeper intimacy with the Father.*
>
> From the video

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Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Pharisees ◆ Fasting ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Righteousness ◆ Image of God

◆ Manna ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Temptation of Jesus ◆ Worship ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Capernaum

◆ Nazareth ◆ Galilee ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Almsgiving ◆ Andrew (apostle) ◆ Anxiety

◆ Augustine of Hippo ◆ The Beatitudes ◆ Bethsaida ◆ Chiasm ◆ Chorazin ◆ Cyprian of Carthage ◆ Didache ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Gentiles ◆ Herod Antipas ◆ Hypocrite ◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Magdala ◆ Mercy ◆ Mishnah ◆ Mount of Beatitudes (traditional site) ◆ New covenant ◆ Nicodemus ◆ Perfection ◆ Prayer ◆ The Prophets (books) ◆ Scribe ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Sermon on the Mount ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Synagogue ◆ Tax collector ◆ Tiberias

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